SCP EQUITY RESEARCH

Skeena Resources, 05 September 2023

Ticker: SKE CN	**Pro forma Cash:** C$71m	**Project**: Eskay Creek
Market cap: C$578m	**Price:** C$6.56/sh	**Country:** Canada, BC
REC. (unc): BUY	*TARGET (unc): C$10.90/sh*	*RISK RATING (unc): HIGH*

We see three main key takeaways from today's Snip MRE update: First, we were pleased to see the resource growing by 45% to a total of 937koz (vs 646koz in 3Q20 maiden MRE), with the additional ounces gained partially from improved metallurgical recoveries (now 96% vs 90% previously) / infill drilling / higher Au price and partially from the discovery of new veins (new number of veins in upd. resource is 94 vs 72 in 3Q20 MRE). Second, with 88% of the resource already in indicated category, we think Skeena can get to PFS quickly (maiden engineering study guided for 1H24) and give to the market a better understanding on the economics of this project, and third, given that (i) indicated resource grade is already >2x the current reserve grade (3.85Moz @ 4g/t AuEq), and (ii) 8,435m of existing UG workings at Snip, we now see potential for high value accretive ounce additions from the V&S veins (775koz @ 9.4g/t in indicated) to the mill schedule and extend it for 2 or even more years, at a low capital intensity, albeit the materiality of it depends on timing and mine schedule. Even better, the concentrate market is all about grade. The high in-site Snip grade practically translates to high concentrate grade, generating very accretive blending option with Eskay Creek's feed for Skeena. Stepping back, in 3Q22 DFS we saw a 73% OP resource conversion to reserve for Eskay and given that the 2Q23 MRE grew substantially to 5.6Moz AuEq with 99% of it in M&I, in our view we can expect a higher conversion rate – perhaps at 85%, that could add ~1Moz (or ~3y of additional LOM). Adding to that the satellite feed from Snip that will not only extend the LOM but also the concentrate's payability, we now see multiple pathways for value growth closer to C$2b. For now, ***we maintain our BUY rating and our C$10.90/sh PT based on 0.6xNAV$_{5\%-1850}$.*** *Looking ahead, the DFS update by year end is the main catalyst to provide more torque to Skeena's share price, alongside with updates on permitting and progress on the financing package. Material updates on permitting / detailed engineering and financing have become more material now given the permitting roadmap (EA certificate by 2H24, final permits to be issued in 1H25) was recently published in 1Q23.*

Table 1. Snip MRE New (3Q23) vs Old (3Q20)

Snip 3Q23 MRE	Tonnes (000t)	Grade Au (g/t)	Au (000oz)	Global (%)
UG indicated resource	2,739	9.35	823	88%
∆ to 3Q20 (%)	+408%	-33%	+237%	+50%
UG Inferred resource	499	7.10	114	12%
∆ to 3Q20 (%)	-47%	-47%	-72%	-50%
UG Global resource	**3,238**	**9.0**	**937**	
∆ to 3Q20 (%)	+119%	-34%	+45%	

Source: Skeena, SCP

Snip MRE grows to 937koz (88% in M&I); potential to extend Eskay Creek LOM by >2 years

The **updated global UG resource** of **937koz @ 9.0g/t** (from 646koz @ 13.6g/t in 3Q20 MRE) sees 88% M&I based on 307 holes/ 46,268m of new drilling. Input parameters remain largely unchanged, with recovery up from 90% to 96%, while gold price was lifted from US$1,550/oz to US$1,700/oz. A maiden engineering study for Snip as a satellite operation to the Eskay Creek project is expected to be completed by 1H24.

Site visit: early construction earthworks already commenced; Eskay Deeps exploration pending results

We were on site last week and came away with three take homes: **First**, we were pleased to see early earthworks having commenced on site, with a focus on preparing the area where the mill and plant will be placed, showing commitment to the guided construction timelines as permitting progresses. **Second**, scaling up drilling with the addition of the Eskay Deeps target (following up last year's discovery hole **32.2m @ 4.5g/t AuEq**) hasn't impeded the team's productivity or quality of work, assisted by the recently constructed assay-lab on site which is used to guide and prioritize exploration targets based on fast drill results = capital and time efficient exploration campaign. **Third**, we came away very impressed with the quality of the team, led by CEO Randy Reichert, applying industry-leading practices that have proved to be effective when he led the development of B2Gold's Fekola mine in Mali. Under his guidance, Skeena has shifted its focus from junior-explorer engineering to reality based scenarios outlined by (i) the recent changes in MRE parameters (new block size reconciles better with historic production and updated met recoveries based on new flowsheet with re-agents added from the start), (i) bringing M&I resources to 99% of total resource – de-risking the mine plan, (iii) upcoming changes to DFS (replacing shovels with smaller backhoe excavators = more selective mining, new simplified flowsheet will deliver higher quality concentrate = potential higher payability), and (iv) construction of the assay lab on site that will help not only during exploration but also during production for reconciliation with mill data.

Figure 1. (A) Aerial view of the camp and (B) equipment from the new assay-lab on site

Source: SCP

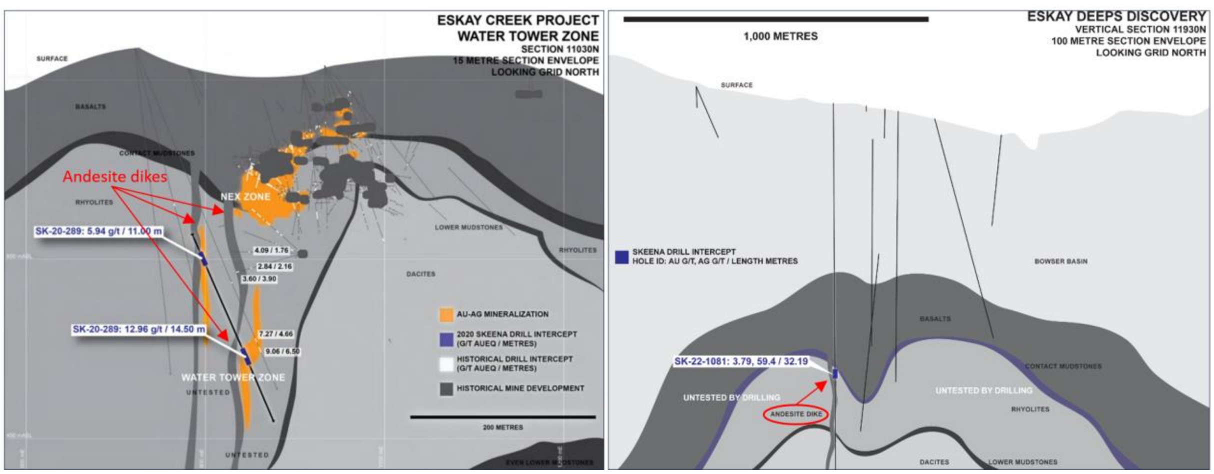
Drill bit momentum in play at Eskay Deeps, looking for bonanza grade mineralization

Last year's discovery hole (SK-22-1081: **32.2m @ 4.5g/t AuEq** at spot – 3.8g/t Au / 59.4g/t Ag) hit rhyolite-hosted mineralization 650m down-dip from the NEX zone at ~850m below surface, with mineralization starting just 4m below the contact mudstone layer – replicating the stratigraphic sequence from higher up, mineralization styles and alternation observed to the other deposits at Eskay Creek. So what? Simply put, we see potential for a game-changing discovery. This thesis is driven by the following observations: First, the thin unmineralized interval of contact mudstone immediately overlying the feeder mineralization was observed in the 21 Zone which was mined by previous operators (Homestake/Barrick) in the historic mine that produced ~3.3Moz Au and 160Moz Ag @ 72.5g/t AuEq (45g/t Au and 2,224g/t Ag) over the LOM. Second, the andesite dikes which, are the least-resistance paths for the geothermal fluids, are a pathfinder to the main plumbing and mineralization system at Eskay and as is depicted in Figure 2, an andesite dike has been discovered adjacent to the 1081 hole. If so obvious, how did Barrick miss that? Mainly for three reasons: Drilling was at a >100m spacing, sampling of the drill holes was selective and focused on the high-grade contact mudstone mineralization, and lastly, due to ground conditions and less advanced drill techniques/equipment many of the drill holes had to be abandoned as they were unable to achieve target depth. Next steps include a 12-15 holes drill program this year (each hole will be ~800m deep, with few reaching up to 1,500m) by 5 different drill pads to trace the extend of this newly discovered structure. Ideally, we would like to see Skeena finding the other side of the andesite dike to get a better understanding of the size of the 'prize'.

Figure 2: Core from Eskay Deeps discovery hole 1081 showing the highest-grade interval (11g/t AuEq)

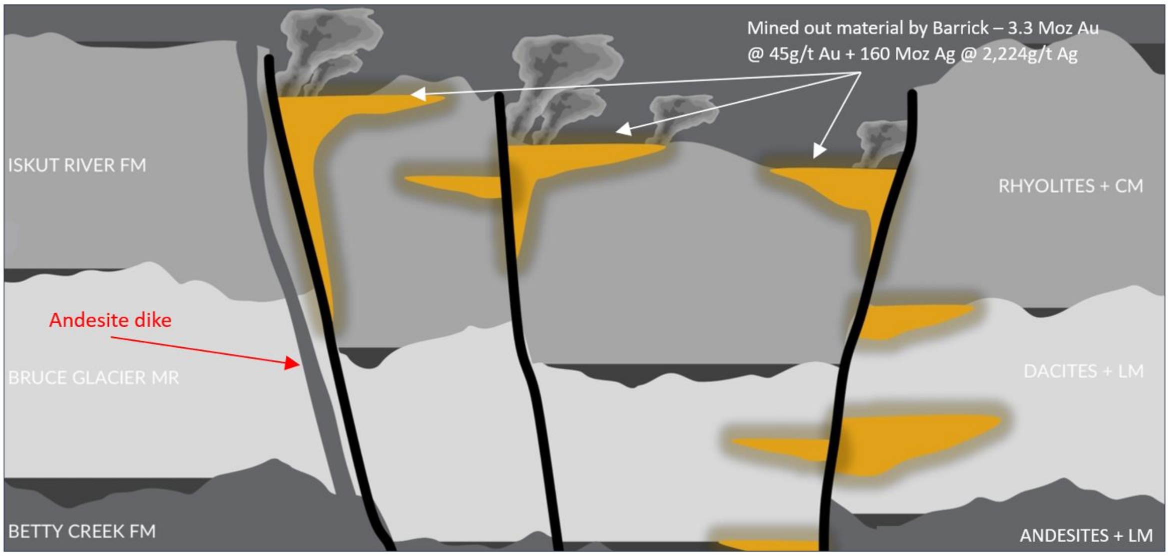
Source: SCP

Figure 3: Correlation of andesite dikes with mineralization at NEX, Water Tower Zones and Eskay Deeps



Source: Skeena, SCP annotations

Figure 4: Simplified VMS genetic model for the Eskay Creek deposit



Source: Skeena, SCP annotations

Existing infrastructure and a high-caliber execution team differentiates Skeena from its Canadian peers

One of Eskay Creek's competitive advantages is undoubtedly the abundance of infrastructure in the area; Highway 37 from Smithers (and a 50km gravel road into Eskay Creek in place), new 287 kV power line and the hydroelectric Volcano Creek Power Station just 17km away from the site, to name a few, allowing Skeena to control its own fate without relying on government subsidies for major infrastructure components. On the execution front, we were pleased to see early earthworks progressing with early foundation work underway at area where the plant will be placed, with the project being on schedule and below budget so far under the lead of the new site manager who brings significant experience from Red Chris. On the corporate level, CEO Randy Reichert brings a wealth of experience in building mines, with most recent example Fekola's mine development and transition to operations in Mali – a skillset necessary in this stage of the project and something that not many peers can claim they have.

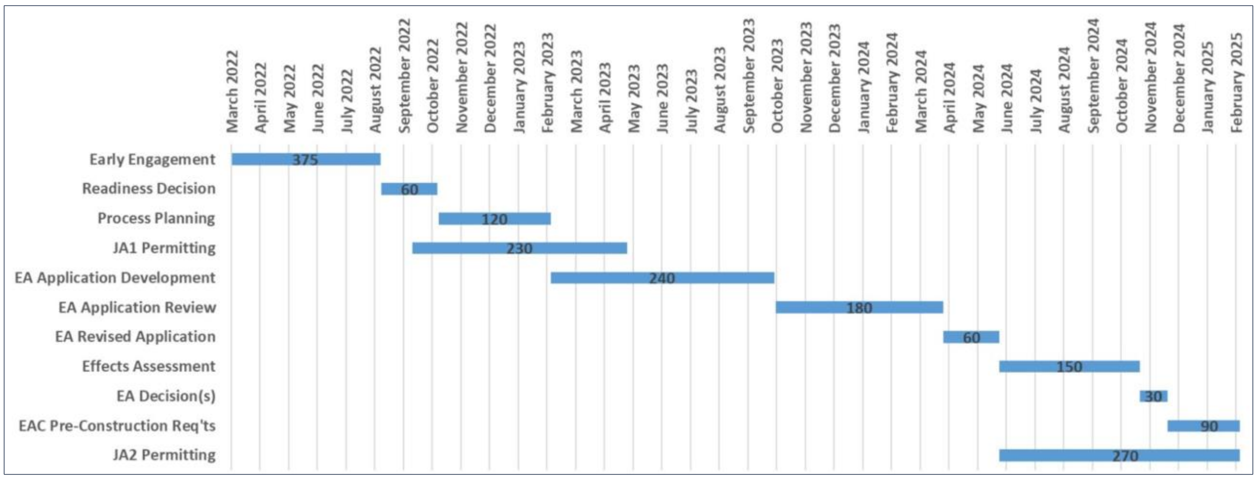
Figure 5: (A) Aerial view of the Volcano Creek power station, (B) earthworks ongoing at the plant area

Source: SCP

Permitting in line with guidance; Talhtan Central Government on board; final permits expected by 1H25

Although BC is considered a stable and favorable jurisdiction for mining, permitting timelines are lengthy. To address this, Skeena is acting proactively during the permitting progress to shorten the timelines. Some examples include the bi-weekly meetings with the assistant deputy minister's table and regular touchpoints and development of collaborative authorization process with the TCG. Additionally, Skeena has initiated discussions with the Talhtan Nation to sign and finalize an Impact Benefit Agreement. So far, Skeena has secured and received approvals for 26 permits out of a total of 62 required, with additional 11 submitted (9 final stage, 2 draft submitted), with the rest 21 being in preparation and scoping study level.

Figure 6: Permitting process timeline



Source: Skeena

Why we like Skeena

1. Large high-grade open pit with SCPe >500koz upside potential in coming 12-18M
2. Shift in market dynamics allows concentrate sales for lower capex
3. Optionality from high-grade Snip mine nearby to blend concentrate or add ounces
4. Catalyst heavy with drilling, metallurgy, and DFS optimizations in coming 12M

Catalysts

1. 2023: Permitting updates
2. 3Q23: Eskay Creek Met optimization/flowsheet
3. 3Q23: Snip MRE update
4. 3Q-4Q23: Eskay Creek exploration results
5. 4Q23: Updated DFS
6. 1Q24: Snip maiden engineering study
7. CY26: SCPe first production

Research

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Ticker: SKE CN	**Price / mkt cap:**	C$6.56/sh, C$578m	**Project PNAV today:**	0.33x	**Asset:**	Eskay Creek / Snip
Author: B Salier	**Rec / 0.6xNAV PT:**	BUY, C$10.9/sh	**1xNAV$_{4Q22}$ FF FD:**	C$19.97/sh	**Country:**	Canada: BC

Commodity price	**CY18A**	**CY19A**	**CY20A**	**CY21A**	**CY22E**
Gold price	1,850	1,850	1,850	1,850	1,850

SOTP *project* valuation*	**C$m**	**O/ship**	**NAVx**	**C$/sh**
Ungeared proj. @ build start	1,746	100%	1.00x	18.37
Pro-forma Cash	71	100%	1.00x	0.75
Cash from options	49	100%	1.00x	0.52
Rsr ex rsv @US$50/oz	108	100%	1.00x	1.14
Snip (US$75/oz)	88	100%	1.00x	0.92
Asset NAV5% C$1850/oz	2,063			21.7
**Shares diluted for options but not mine build*		Market P/NAV$_{5\%\ 3Q22}$		0.30x

Share data			
Basic shares (m)	88.2	FD with build equity raise	122.3
FD with options (m)	95.1		

Asset value: 1xNPV project @ build start (C$m, ungeared)*					
Project NPV (C$m)*	$1650oz	$1750oz	$1850oz	$1950oz	$2050oz
10.0% discount	1,349	1,476	1,602	1,728	1,854
7.5% discount	1,531	1,672	1,814	1,955	2,095
5.0% discount	1,745	1,904	**2,063**	2,221	2,380
Ungeared project IRR:	44%	47%	51%	54%	57%
Project NPV (C$/sh)*	$1650oz	$1750oz	$1850oz	$1950oz	$2050oz
10.0% discount	14.19	15.52	16.85	18.18	19.50
7.5% discount	16.10	17.59	19.08	20.56	22.04
5.0% discount	18.35	20.03	**21.7**	23.37	25.04

**Project level NPV, excl finance costs and central SG&A, discounted to build start*

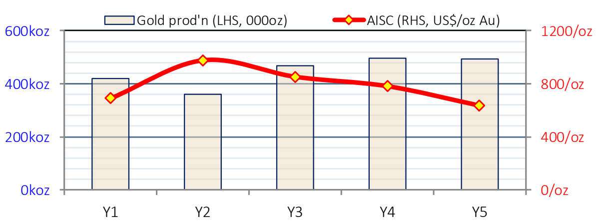
Group valuation over time^	**Sep-23**	**Sep-24**	**Sep-25**	**Sep-26**	**Sep-27**
Eskay Creek (C$m)	1,770	1,978	2,342	2,597	2,258
Net cash prior qtr (C$m)	73	79	(178)	(360)	38
G&A and finance costs (C$m)	(81)	(94)	(85)	(49)	(10)
Cash from options (C$m)	49	49	49	49	49
Snip	88	88	88	88	88
NAV FF FD (C$m)	1,899	2,101	2,216	2,325	2,423
1xNAV$_{5\%}$/sh FF FD (C$/sh)	**19.97^**	**17.17***	**18.11***	**19.00***	**19.81***

Geared company NAV diluted for mine build, net G&A and finance costs					
1xNAV FF FD (C$/sh)^	$1650oz	$1750oz	$1850oz	$1950oz	$2050oz
10.0% discount	1,897	2,069	2,241	2,414	2,586
7.5% discount	1,971	2,150	2,328	2,506	2,685
5.0% discount	2,053	2,238	**2,423**	2,608	2,794
Geared project IRR:	42%	45%	48%	51%	54%
1xNAV FF FD (C$/sh)^	$1650oz	$1750oz	$1850oz	$1950oz	$2050oz
10.0% discount	13.87	15.54	17.22	18.91	20.62
7.5% discount	14.96	16.70	18.46	20.24	22.02
5.0% discount	16.13	17.96	**19.8**	21.67	23.53

*^Project NPV incl grp SG&A & fin. cost, +net cash; *diluted for mine build equity*

Production	**Y1**	**Y2**	**Y3**	**Y4**	**Y5**
Gold production (000oz)	420	361	469	496	493
C1 cost (US$/oz)	611	897	722	656	590
AISC cost (US$/oz)	691	978	854	783	636

AISC = C1 + ug sustaining capex, Y1 = 12M to Mar 2027



Source: SCP estimates

Resource / Reserve	**AuEq (koz)**	**AuEq (g/t)**
Pittable resource	5631koz	3.46g/t
Underground resource	393koz	5.86g/t
Snip	937koz	9.00g/t

Funding: uses		**Funding: sources**	
Build Capex	C$592m	Pro-forma Cash	C$88m
SCPe G&A to 1st Au + NSR buyback	C$18m	Mine debt @ 65% gearing	C$385m
SCPe pre-production expl'n	C$0m	Mine build equity at 0.4xNAV	C$207m
SCPe finance costs + wkg cap	C$31m	Total proceeds	C$680m
Total uses	C$640m	*Buffer*	*C$39m*

**Cash from options expiring pre first pour*

Ratio analysis	**CY21A**	**CY22E**	**CY23E**	**CY24E**	**CY25E**
Average shares out (m)	92.3	71.5	86.4	104.1	104.1
EPS (C$/sh)	-	-	-	-	-
CFPS (C$/sh)	-	-	-	-	-
EV (C$m)	566.6	434.4	412.0	719.4	1,021.8
FCF yield (%)	-	-	-	-	-
PER (x)	-	-	-	-	-
P/CF (x)	-	-	-	-	-
EV/EBITDA (x)	-	-	-	-	32.1x

Income statement	**CY21A**	**CY22E**	**CY23E**	**CY24E**	**CY25E**
Net revenue (C$m)	-	-	-	-	40.7
Gross profit (C$m)	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**32.6**
D&A, attrib (C$m)	0.3	0.3	0.1	-	5.9
Admin (C$m)	22.9	21.2	18.7	10.7	-
Expensed exploration (C$m)	107.5	91.6	25.7	-	-
Finance cost (C$m)	(0.2)	(0.4)	(0.7)	-	24.6
Royalty (C$m)	-	(9.5)	-	-	0.8
Forex, other (C$m)	(12.8)	(14.3)	(0.6)	-	-
Taxes (C$m)	-	-	-	-	3.7
Net income (C$m)	**(117.6)**	**(88.9)**	**(43.3)**	**(10.7)**	**(2.3)**

Cash flow, attrib.	**CY21A**	**CY22E**	**CY23E**	**CY24E**	**CY25E**
EBIT (C$m)	(117.8)	(89.3)	(44.0)	(10.7)	26.0
Add back D&A (C$m)	0.3	0.3	0.1	-	5.9
Less tax + net interest (C$m)	(0.2)	(0.4)	(0.7)	-	28.3
Net change in wkg cap (C$m)	(10.3)	6.2	(2.6)	(1.2)	(9.7)
Add back other non-cash (C$m)	1.4	(3.1)	5.4	-	-
Cash flow ops (C$m)	**(126.1)**	**(85.5)**	**(40.4)**	**(11.9)**	**(6.2)**
PP&E - build + sust. (C$m)	(13.1)	11.8	(40.5)	(179.3)	(296.3)
PP&E - expl'n (C$m)	(0.5)	(0.4)	22.5	-	-
Cash flow inv. (C$m)	**(13.5)**	**11.4**	**(18.0)**	**(179.3)**	**(296.3)**
Share issue (C$m)	137.0	82.7	174.9	-	-
Proceeds from sale (C$m)	5.0	-	-	-	-
Debt draw (repay) (C$m)	(1.6)	(0.5)	-	-	409.8
Cash flow fin. (C$m)	**140.5**	**82.3**	**174.9**	**-**	**409.8**
Net change in cash (C$m)	0.8	8.1	116.6	(191.1)	107.4
EBITDA (C$m)	*(117.5)*	*(89.0)*	*(43.9)*	*(10.7)*	*31.8*

Balance sheet	**CY21A**	**CY22E**	**CY23E**	**CY24E**	**CY25E**
Cash (C$m)	40.3	40.6	158.0	(33.1)	74.2
Acc rec., inv, prepaid (C$m)	13.9	9.5	8.9	10.1	8.0
PP&E + other (C$m)	100.8	117.9	132.3	311.5	601.9
Total assets (C$m)	**155.0**	**168.0**	**299.2**	**288.5**	**684.1**
Debt (C$m)	1.3	6.1	3.3	3.3	413.1
Accounts payable (C$m)	12.5	14.0	12.5	12.5	0.6
Others (C$m)	17.6	10.7	9.6	9.6	9.6
Total liabilities (C$m)	31.4	30.8	25.4	25.4	423.3
Sh'hlds equity + wrnts (C$m)	362.0	465.3	642.5	642.5	642.5
Retained earn'gs + rsvs (C$m)	(238.4)	(328.1)	(368.7)	(379.4)	(381.7)
Liabilities + equity (C$m)	**155.0**	**168.0**	**299.2**	**288.5**	**684.1**

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1	SCP collectively beneficially owns 1% or more of any class of the issuer's equity securities[1]	**NO**
2	The analyst or any associate of the analyst responsible for the report or recommendation or any individual directly involved in the preparation of the report holds or is short any of the issuer's securities directly or through derivatives	**NO**
3	An SCP partner, director, officer or analyst involved in the preparation of a report on the issuer, has during the preceding 12 months provided services to the issuer for remuneration other than normal course investment advisory or trading execution services	**NO**
4	SCP has provided investment banking services for the issuer during the 12 months preceding the date of issuance of the research report or recommendation	**YES**
5	Name of any director, officer, employee or agent of SCP who is an officer, director or employee of the issuer, or who serves in an advisory capacity to the issuer	**NO**
6	SCP is making a market in an equity or equity related security of the issuer	**NO**
7	The analyst preparing this report received compensation based upon SCP's investment banking revenue for the issuer	**NO**
8	The analyst has conducted a site visit and has viewed a major facility or operation of the issuer	**YES**
9	The analyst has been reimbursed for travel expenses for a site visit by the issuer	**NO**

SCP Resource Finance Equity Research Ratings:

Summary of Recommendations as of September 2023	
BUY:	53
HOLD:	0
SELL:	0
UNDER REVIEW:	0
TENDER:	0
NOT RATED:	0
TOTAL	53

[1] As at the end of the month immediately preceding the date of issuance of the research report or the end of the second most recent month if the issue date is less than 10 calendar days after the end of the most recent month